

# SYLLABLE CLAPPING

## Aim

This activity helps to develop a child's understanding that words are made up of parts (known as syllables) and their awareness of how many parts are in a given word.

## Target

For the child to be able to identify the number of syllables in a range of 1-4 syllable words.

## Resources

- Objects from around the house and/or the pictures provided of 1-4 syllable words.
- Syllable counting hands- see attached.
- Syllable clapping board game- see attached.

## HOW TO COMPLETE THE ACTIVITY:

1. It might be easier to use the word 'claps' or 'taps' when introducing syllables to the child e.g. "how many claps are in it?". You need to model syllables first, for the child to begin to understand how you are breaking up words:

- Try clapping out people's names e.g. 'Em-i-ly'.
- Tap on the table the number of syllables in objects around you e.g. 'book' 'pen-cil' 'ru-ler'.
- Point out items in books/ catalogues and identify the syllables e.g. 'ae-ro-plane', 'sun-shine'.

2. When the child is ready to start identifying the syllables themselves, you could try any of the ideas above with the child taking a turn, or use any objects/pictures provided to:

- Put pictures in appropriate boxes, labelled with the 1/2/3/4 syllable hands for the number of syllables. Adult could say either 1,2,3 or 4 and child finds a picture with that number of syllables.
- Do the same as above but provide your child with a picture/object and ask them to place it in the correct box.
- Use a large sized colouring-in picture of an object e.g. elephant. Identify the number of syllables, then let the child cut the picture into the same number of pieces.



When your child is confident sorting pictures/objects into the number of syllables, play our syllable clapping board game! Encourage your child to say and clap out the word and then tell you how many syllables it has.

### Any Questions?

Please contact the speech and language therapy service on:

0300 555 5965



Cambridgeshire and  
Peterborough  
NHS Foundation Trust

---

## RESOURCES:

---

### SYLLABLE COUNTING HANDS:



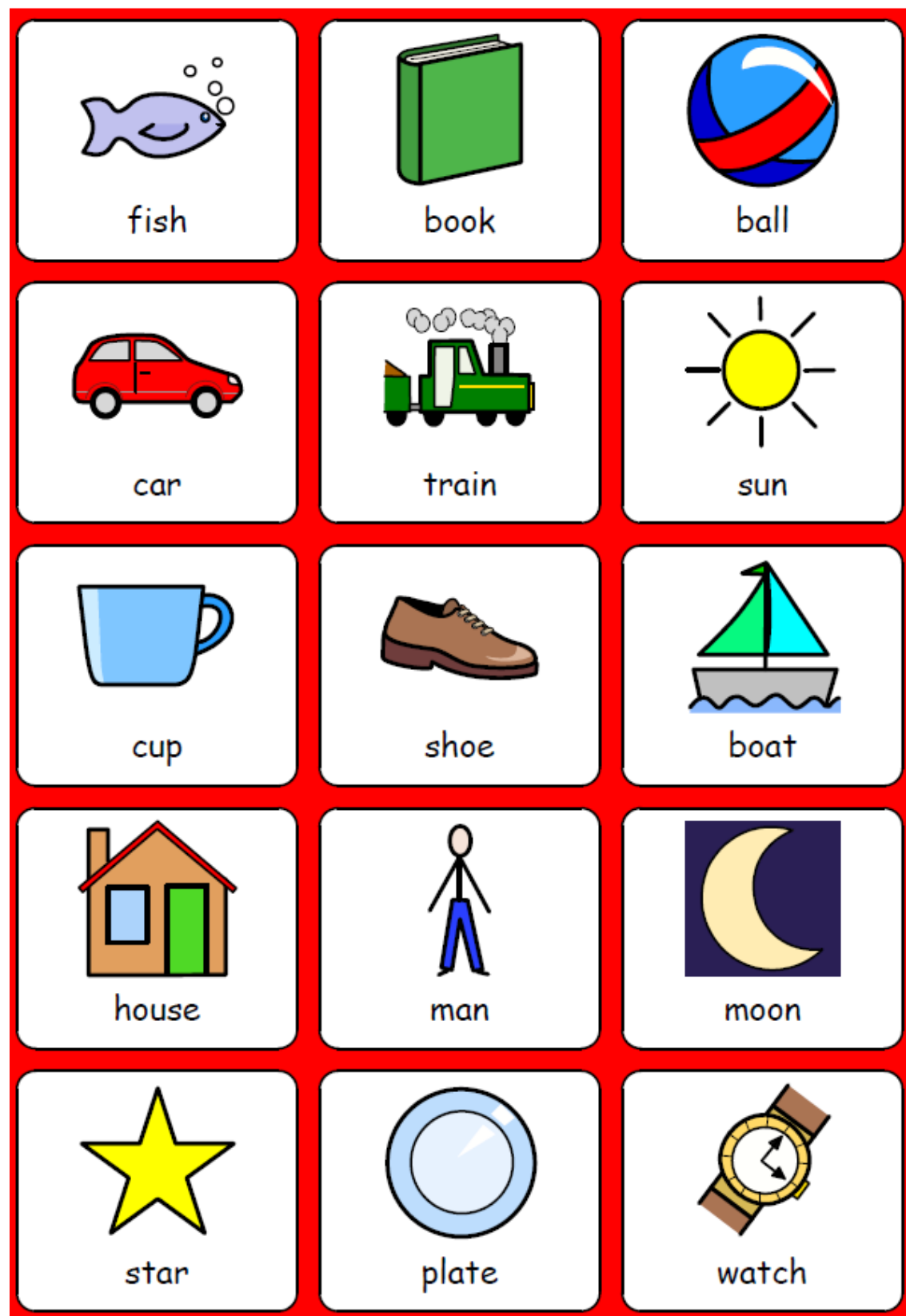


3



4

## 1 SYLLABLE PICTURES:



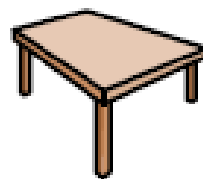
## 2 SYLLABLE PICTURES:



apple



monkey



table



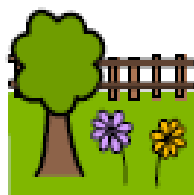
bubbles



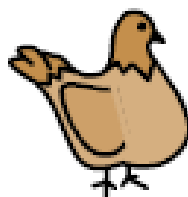
rainbow



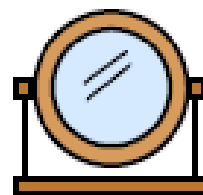
finger



garden



chicken



mirror



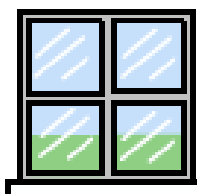
baby



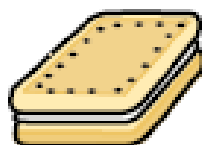
pencil



puzzle



window

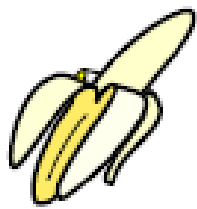


biscuit

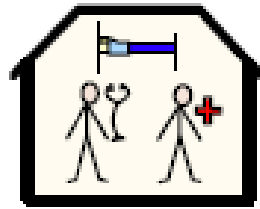


jumper

### 3 SYLLABLE PICTURES:



banana



hospital



telephone



computer



animals



lollipop



dinosaur



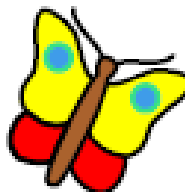
sausages



aeroplane



umbrella



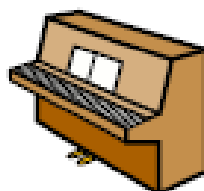
butterfly



elephant



waterfall



piano

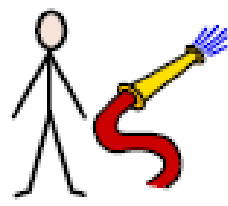


holiday

#### 4 SYLLABLE PICTURES:



watermelon



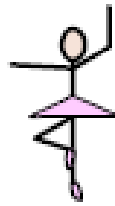
firefighter



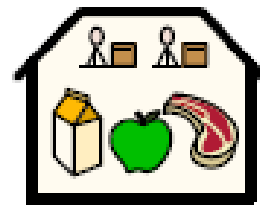
washing machine



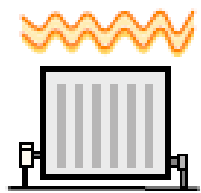
crocodile



ballerina



supermarket



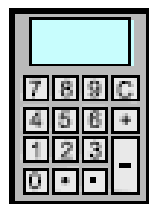
radiator



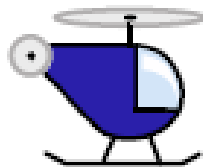
alien



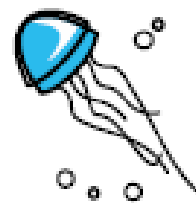
caterpillar



calculator



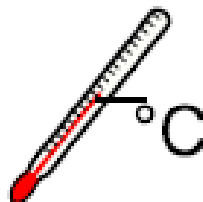
helicopter



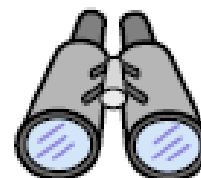
jellyfish



aquarium



temperature



binoculars

# SYLLABLE CLAPPING BOARD GAME:

